

Year 1964, Third Epoch

All I've researched, everything I've accomplished, my entire life has led to this. This one discovery has the potential to lift me from a simple novice at the Arcanum to my rightful place among the upper echelons of academic society. Beyond them, even. My name shall be recorded alongside the legends of history, should my hypotheses be correct. I mustn't forget my origins, however, as it was through my humble beginnings that the path towards my destiny was revealed.

I was raised in a small, northern village, a self-taught arcanist. I grew up listening to the ridiculous folktales of my people. Stories of heroes and high lords battling the foulest of abominations. With the truth of these tales, surely lost to time, they were of little interest to me. In fact, feeling as though my talent was being wasted surrounded by inferior minds, I soon left my village and traveled to the Praxium Arcanum to further my education in the arcane arts.

However, once again my potential was stifled. I, of course, easily passed the entrance examination but as an initiate I was given menial tasks. For months, I toiled, wiping tables, sweeping laboratories, discarding outdated tomes... It was amidst this drudgery that I came across the catalyst of my expedition.

I was preparing the research journals of the disgraced Professor Laclérmont for incineration, following his recent expulsion from the Arcanum, when one fell off the stack. I bent to retrieve it off the ground but stopped when I realized I recognized the map that was sketched on the page the book had flipped open to. It was a map of an area not far from my village. On a whim, I briefly skimmed the research documentation to discover Laclérmont had been investigating an ancient relic, one of unparalleled potency. Professor Laclérmont was known for his interest in ancient artifacts and the power they may still hold, but in his own words "the subject of this query is leagues above all other archaeological findings in the last three centuries, regarding its potential impact on our understanding of magic and the whole of Verdara".



Laclérmont had collected a vast array of stories and legends, many of which I was familiar with from my childhood, that contained any mention of a relic known broadly as the Vaelith Reliquary. This object was thought to be able to trap and hold the soul of a god, or at least a portion of it. Further, using his knowledge of transference runes, Laclérmont had theorized a method of binding a fragment of Mylaris, the Aether that created the Runic Mythros itself, to this Vaelith Reliquary and using it to completely uncap the wielder's magical capacity. What Laclérmont proposed was a viable path to limitless power!

The only obstacle Laclérmont faced was an unfamiliarity to the area where the Reliquary was said to be hidden, an obstacle that does not impede me. Following a trivial geographical study of the mountainous region surrounding my old village, I believe I have identified the exact location of the Reliquary.

Laclérmont's notes became frantic near the end. He spoke of a final barrier that guards the Reliquary. He claimed that the keepers of the relic do not lock their gates with metal, but with the 'reflections of the those who wish to enter.' I suspect this is merely poetic metaphor, but I must remain vigilant for any illusions on my search.

My petition for a sabbatical to return to my village has already been approved. I am not blind to the possibility that the relic I seek may be well guarded; however, I cannot trust my peers at the Arcanum not to betray me in the final moments and claim the prize for themselves. For this reason, I have hired specialized individuals to accompany me on this journey. Capable as they may be, these brutes will be far less likely to recognize the true potential of the relic and less interested in it even if they do, once they've been paid.

I stand on the brink of greatness. All I must do is claim it. And claim it, I shall, fervently. Before long, I will be one of the most powerful beings on the face of the world!